

Samsung Omnia
Expensive But Imperfect

The Samsung Omnia is another one of those awaited phones. In a market already flooded with Windows Mobile phones with touchscreens, the Omnia hits the Indian market all ready with the all new Windows Mobile 6.1.

The phone has a very minimalistic design, which is now more or less the norm for all touch screen phones. There are some slight appealing touches in the design, like the grooves around the camera that reflect rainbow colours and the mirror like casing around the touch screen.

There is a common port for interfacing with the computer and the headset, but this is set in the side of the phone. The stylus does not dock into the phone, but you can dangle it from the phone like an ill-attached limb if you want. The stylus is telescopic, and telescopes out almost magically when the cap is opened.

The touch screen does not respond to touch as



much as it responds to pressure — you have to press the screen to get anything done. There are some glaring mistakes — it is impossible to scroll down the playlist in the “touch player”. The on-call menu locks itself every three seconds, which means you have to press an action button and a button on the screen just to activate the speaker. The screen mode is eccentric and inconsistent. It switches from portrait to landscape at its own violation, and then misbehaves when you turn the phone to specifically change it. The

phone has a cursor feature which makes touch navigation easier.

Programs take time to load, true even for the clock or the phonebook. The start menu disappears when you close programs at times. There is a great feature that lets the phone behave as external memory for both the phone and the mem-card memory. The camera has many modes to play around with, and powerful flash that stays on for some time which helps in taking photos. The image quality is not great. There is a panorama mode restricted to 180 degrees. The photos tend to be a little overexposed, the background is focused in the portrait mode, and the camera cannot clearly focus anything closer than 3 inches to the lens even in the macro mode. The sound quality while using the headset is excellent, helped by the tunnel earplugs. There is little punch in the bass, but the other frequencies are handled well. The speaker is not too loud, and playing any song using the speaker is sounds appalling.

The phone ships with three sets of earpads for the headset, for different ear sizes. A nice touch is that the headset has a standard pin that allows you to plug in your own headphones to the device.

This is a phone for the high end market. At Rs 35,999, it’s still very expensive. Buy it only if you want the flaunting features like the GPS and the 5 MP camera.

Specifications

3.2-inch touchscreen Windows Mobile 6.1 Professional, Bluetooth 2.0, Wi-Fi, 5 MP Camera, Built-in GPS

Contact: Samsung Telecommunications India
Phone: 011 - 41511234
E-mail: joydeep.r@samsung.com
Web site: http://in.samsungmobile.com
Price: Rs 35,999 for 24 GB and 37,999 for 32 GB

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★
Overall	★★★★

Corsair Voyager GT 16GB
Fast Stuff But With More Cargo Space

Flash drive with higher capacities might have been around and prices might have dropped but there was always something missing — performance. The all new Corsair Voyager GT 16GT completes the empty spaces.

This drive like some of the other premium flash drives from the competition comes in a rubber body and a cap. This also makes it waterproof and shockproof. The package comes with an USB extension cable so you don’t have to plug the drive at the rear of the cabinet. A

bunch of tests were run on the drive and the performance in general was pretty impressive.

SiSoft Sandra recorded a drive index score of 30MBps. Random access time was a minimal 1 ms. HD Tach recorded an average read speed of 31.1 MBps and an average write of 14.4 MBps, both of which are really good for a flash drive. The maximum burst speed was recorded at 33 MBps.

Even real world tests which we run gave similar results. A 1 GB file was copied to the drive in just a



though this is supposed to be one of the higher-end flash drives, it makes good value for money.

Specifications

Capacity: 16 GB, Dimensions: 72 x 22 x 12 mm, Weight: 16 g

Contact: Tirupati Enterprises
Phone: 9339207519
E-mail: mail@tirupati.net
Web site: www.corsair.com
Price: Rs 2,200

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

minute three seconds. A three gigabyte file could be read in 1 minute 46 seconds. Reading multiple smaller files of 3 GB was a bit slower as expected. The real hit was when multiple files were written to the drive. It took 8 minutes 59 seconds to transfer.

The price for the drive is Rs 2,200. That’s not very expensive for the performance and the sturdy build quality that you get. Even

Seagate FreeAgent XTreme 1000 GB
Bigger Is Better And Now It Can Be Smaller Too!



External hard drives based generally tend to miss out on capacity or on style. It always seems like portable drives are lagging behind somewhere or the other. The Seagate FreeAgent XTreme 1000 GB is one of the most stylish drives to see the light of day. The 1 TB of space should please many.

In size, the FreeAgent XTreme 1000 GB case is fairly large but thinner than before. The drive stands vertical on a thin support plat-

form. This setup makes it very simple to pack up and carry along with you. Setting up the drive is simple. The drive with all three interfaces — USB, Firewire and eSATA.

Performance isn’t shabby either. SiSoft Sandra recorded a drive index of 33 MBps and a random access time of 13ms. HDTach recorded a higher average read speed of 36 MBps. We then did a test of copying 4 GB of data using a single

file and then same with multiple smaller files. A 4 GB file could be written in two minutes thirty four seconds and copied back in a minute twenty four seconds. Writing of smaller files took two minutes forty nine seconds and reading two minutes twenty one seconds. These are very good but nowhere as close to internal desktop drives. We even tried connecting the drive using Firewire. There was only a two to three per cent improvement in performance. The drive comes built-in with software for security and also to help sync data when you use the drive on another system.

For this capacity and performance, one has to be willing to shell out a good bit of money. This terabyte monster is priced at Rs 14,500. This is a lot more

than a proper desktop hard drive. A missing feature is the network connectivity. With it, the high price tag would be better justified. Still, if you need large capacity and portable drives with some sense of style, then this drive is the right one for you.

Specifications

Capacity: 1 TB, Supports USB 2.0, eSATA, Firewire 400
Dimensions: 175 x 33.7 x 172 mm, Weight: 1.39 kg

Contact: Fortune Marketing
Phone: 022-28508995
E-mail: sales@fortune-it.com
Web site: www.seagate.com
Price: Rs 14,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★
Overall	★★★★

Altec Lansing FX3022
Twin Towers Of Sound

The all new Altec Lansing FX3022 set of speakers are one of the unique designs we’ve come to see from speaker manufacturers. These speakers are also unique for another reason — they have down-firing woofer units at the bottom of both speakers. Altec Lansing claims that this can create double the bass in half the space. We tested these speakers to see how real these claims were.

The FX3022’s look like two towers and sit on your desk. The units are glossy and have a protruding cylinder-like shape where the other driver sits behind. There are no separate woofer unit that sits on the ground. No remote controls come with this speaker set. The On / Off switch along with the volume buttons

are placed are placed on the top of one of the speakers.

We turned on the speakers to see if they were any good. The first impression is that they aren’t very loud but as speakers that you keep on your desk, it’s more than enough. The bass is rather disappointing as well. The down-firing bass units require a solid surface to sit on. They are best kept on the ground but then you need to be sitting at the same level to listen to them. The frequency range of these speakers starts from 40 Hz which is a little higher than most speakers. Even the higher-end range is capped to around 16,000 Hz. The



extreme low bass is non-existent in these speakers. The only bass you get is from the harder drums and that too is absorbed by the table.

The other frequencies sound alright. They don’t distort at all with the volume set to maximum. The only shrill distortion can be heard with songs with high pitched vocals. The sound otherwise is very bright and detailed.

For a speaker without a dedicated subwoofer, the price of Rs 5,490 is quite a

lot. The old Altec Lansing MX5021 was a lot more powerful and better sounding set of speakers and they were priced at around Rs 6,000 to Rs 7,000. If you want something that looks out of the world and something to sit on your desk, then the FX3022’s are good. Just don’t expect ground rumbling power.

Specifications

Power: 25 W, Frequency range: 40 Hz to 16 KHz
Dimensions: 134 x 134 x 254mm

Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-67090828
E-mail: response@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.alteclansing.com
Price: Rs 5,490

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★